

World In A Browser

Last month, the focus of our *Fast Track to The Web* was the PC—how to get it connected to the Internet, and all the essential software you need for your online activities—browsing the Web, chatting with friends and so on. This month, we explore all that you can do online—you’d be surprised at what you can accomplish with just a browser!

No doubt you’ve heard of—if not actually used—the many online office suites that claim to threaten Microsoft Office’s position in the office application category. Google recently added Presentation to its offering, completing the Holy Trinity of documents, spreadsheets and presentations. Zoho’s been around for a while, and new features are added every day. Not as prominent is ThinkFree, which impressed us nonetheless. In the first chapter, you’ll get what you need to start using these applications.

Once you’re done with business, you can indulge in a pleasure that so many people are—blogging. Blogging engines give you a platform to create a spiffy new blog in minutes, and if you still can’t come to terms with them, Chapter 2 will reveal All. We’ve also looked at the new “microblogging” engines, that don’t demand as much of your time—just a short quip about what you’re up to, and that’s it!

There’s been a lot of talk of an online version of Adobe Photoshop lately, but while we wait for that, other players have started offering us easy-to-use, free, online image editors that’ll even send your photos to services like Flickr or Picasa when you’re done editing them!

That done, you can participate in the activity that’s hogging the majority of the world’s collective bandwidth—file sharing! Whether it’s BitTorrent, eMule, Gnutella or Direct Connect—if it’s controversial activity you hanker for, this is your primer.

And finally, from the deep, dark trenches of the Web, we’ve dug out services and Web sites that’ll give you software advice, reviews, and even a friendly hand when things go wrong.

So get that browser window open now!